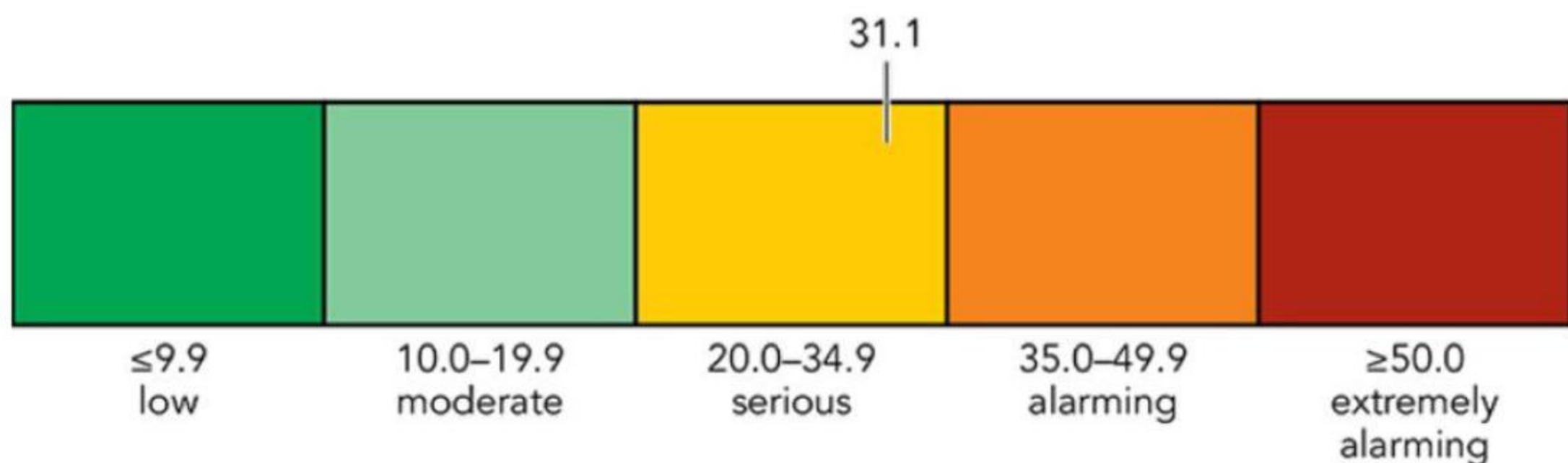


10.4 Detailed specific example: Haiti

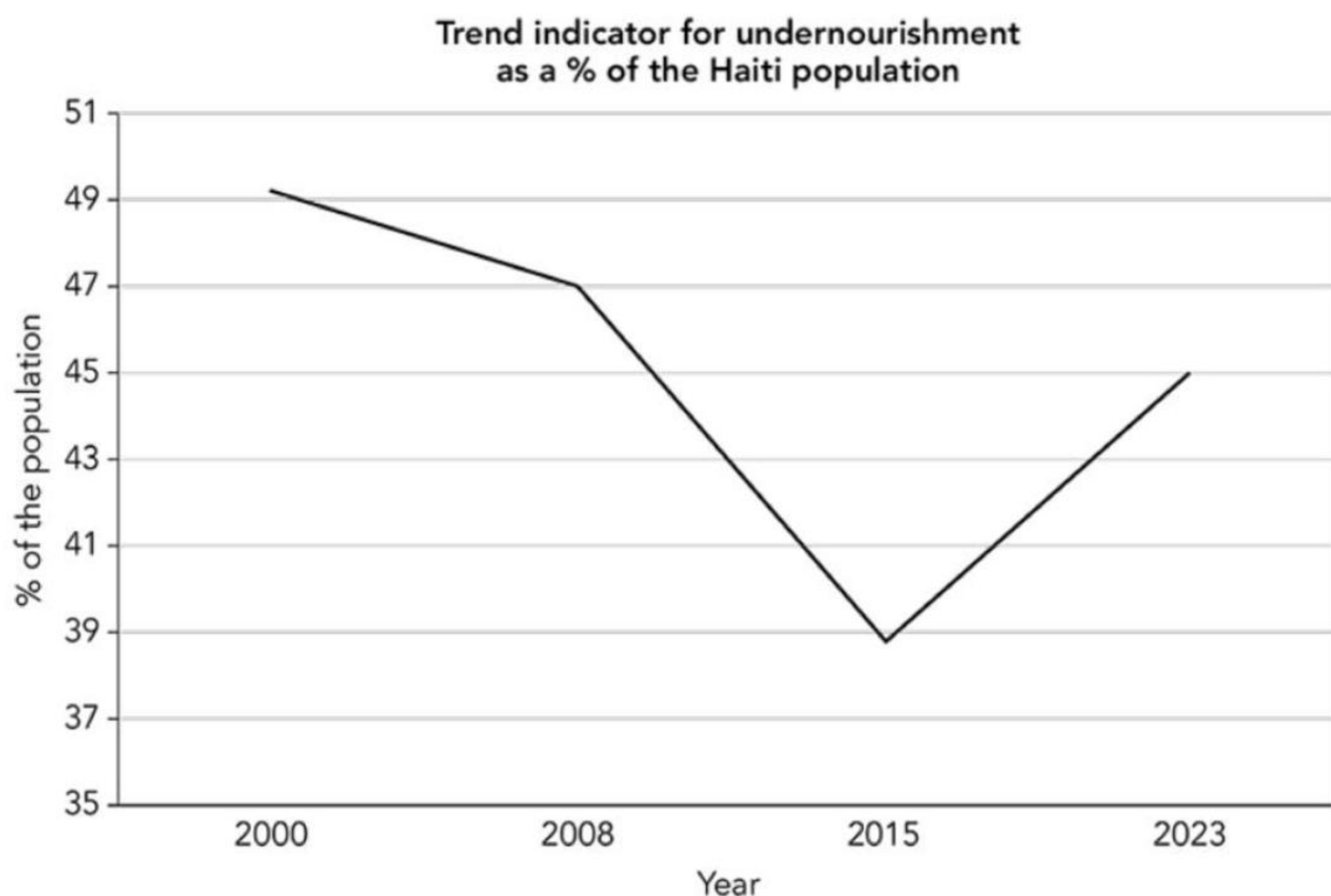


The Republic of Haiti is the third largest country in the Caribbean, located between North and South America. It has an estimated population of 11.4 million people and occupies the western side of the island of Hispaniola.

According to the World Food Programme (WFP), Haiti has the highest level of food insecurity in the world, with a total of 4.35 million Haitians facing acute hunger, and 1.8 million facing emergency levels of food insecurity. In addition to insufficient food, there is the challenge of the poor nutritional value of the food that is available. 22% of children in the country are chronically malnourished, 10% are underweight, and 66% of those under five years old suffer from anaemia due to the lack of iron in their diet. It must be noted that as over half of those living in the food crisis in Haiti are children, the situation is considered a 'children's crisis'.



Source A: The Global Hunger Index (GHI) for Haiti. In 2023, Haiti had a score of 31.1 which is considered serious. This has decreased from a GHI of 40.2 in 2008 but has increased from 30.1 in 2015.



Source B: Trends for undernourishment for Haiti between 2000 and 2023

- a **Calculate the decrease** in GHI for Haiti between 2008 and 2023.
- b **Calculate the percentage change** in GHI for Haiti between 2015 and 2023.
- c **Describe the change** in the percentage of people in Haiti that were undernourished between the year 2000 and 2023. Remember to use data to support your answer (the year and the percentage observed).
- d Use the following data to **plot a line graph** to show the change in GHI in Haiti between 2008 and 2023.

Year	GHI Score for Haiti
2000	40.3
2008	40.2
2015	30.1
2023	31.1

Causes of food insecurity in Haiti

Historically, Haiti has been politically unstable and has the lowest Human Development Index (HDI) in the Americas. In the 21st century, the country has endured a number of factors that have put pressure on food supplies:

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- A political coup and ongoing economic deterioration with increasing crime rates, which all impact the ability of a country to produce and supply food to the population.
- A catastrophic earthquake in 2010 that killed approximately 250 000 people, damaging infrastructure, transport routes, and food supply chains.
- A cholera outbreak in the aftermath of the earthquake, which caused death and weakened the workforce, reducing food production.
- Frequent hurricanes which bring strong winds and flooding, destroying crops and infrastructure. Haiti is the third most affected country by extreme weather events this century.
- Long periods of recurring drought and the drying out of water sources causing crops to fail.
- Poor soils that limit crop growth.
- Poor performance in the agricultural sector and heavy dependence on food imports (more than 83% of the rice is imported). This makes the country vulnerable to increases in the international food prices, with major food products on the island being 30–70% higher than other countries in the region.

These have all caused deepening levels of poverty within the population, which have resulted in high levels of food insecurity.

Problems caused by food insecurity

The lack of access to a balanced diet results in many health and social issues within the population. These range from increased incidents of malnutrition and starvation to crime or social unrest. Statistics show that 22% of all children are malnourished, 10% are underweight, and 66% of all children under the age of five suffer from anaemia. High rates of hunger also result in children missing school and falling behind in their education. The population in general is also at higher risk of contracting illnesses such as cholera and being too ill to work.

All of these factors reduce the ability of the population to work and add to the problem of Haiti’s continued economic decline. This results in those at risk remaining in the poverty cycle where hunger leads to illness, which leads to the inability to work or produce food, which in turn leads back to hunger.

TASK 2

- a In pairs, discuss the problems that food insecurity causes for the Haitian population. Then explain in 100 to 150 words how social unrest and increased crime rates are caused by food insecurity, which in turn will also increase food insecurity.
- b Explain how missed schooling can impact the ability of a person to either grow food or buy food in the future.
- c One in five children in Haiti does not live with a parent. Explain how this will affect the food security of the parentless child.

Managing food insecurity

There are various strategies and techniques that can be employed to combat food insecurity. These are dependent on the political stability, level of economic development, and the climate of a country. In Haiti, the strategies and techniques outlined in Table 10.3 have been used to help battle food shortages.

Table 10.3: Programmes to battle food shortages in Haiti

Programmes	Strategies and techniques
World Food Programme, supplying feeding solutions to Haiti since 1969: • food aid • financial aid • training and developing farming and food management skills.	Strategies: • works with the government to build sustainable food systems and address the roots of food insecurity • developed a School Feeding Policy and Strategy with the government to deliver nutritious meals to almost 300 000 disadvantaged school students in over 1000 schools daily. Techniques: • produces meals to assist with feeding more than 150 000 people affected by the prolonged drought • works with over 70 agricultural organisations to source food from smallholding farmers to sell locally • provides training to farmers and food processing organisations to optimise farm output and reduce post-harvest losses during transport and storage of food products • works with the government to develop food stores for use during emergency situations, like hurricanes or earthquakes.
The Eat Better Programme (Manje pi Byen)	Strategies: • supported by the US Agency for International development, aims to improve food security for extremely vulnerable people in Cité Soleil • assists with economic recovery and market system development, which will help with long-term stability in food supplies. Techniques: • offers food e-vouchers that allow 4000 families access to high-quality foods from local market vendors • offers nutrition and food security assistance.
USAID's Office of Food for Peace and the UN WFP's 2020 drought relief	Techniques: • provides cash transfers for food to approximately 190 000 food-insecure people • provision of food and seed vouchers to more than 55 000 food-insecure people.

The ongoing political instability along with frequent natural disasters in Haiti make implementing these strategies and techniques challenging, and therefore limits their success. The ongoing rise in food insecurity and malnutrition suggest that these strategies, although well meaning, are yet to have a large impact on the level of food security in Haiti.



Source C: Housing in the informal settlements of Port Au Prince, the capital city of Haiti

TIP

When considering solutions to helping people with food insecurity, you must always remember to consider the best long-term solution. Food aid and financial support are both short-term options. If they are used for too long, the population becomes dependent on that support and potentially loses the ability to support themselves.

TASK 3: Study Source C

- Give three reasons why it is difficult for families to provide their own food in this urban setting.
- Different strategies are employed to assist with food supply to areas in need. **With reference to the table below, describe and explain the changes** in both financial aid and food aid between the years of 2018 and 2023.

Table 10.4: Financial and food aid supplied to Haiti from international sources between 2018 and 2023

Year	U.S. dollars	Metric tons of food
2018	\$27.7 million	0
2019	\$27.8 million	2 560 MT
2020	\$15.0 million	2 590 MT
2023	\$47 million	7 500 MT

- With a partner, select one strategy to argue as the best option for improving food supply. Different pairs in the class must investigate different strategies to argue as the best option for improving food supply. Write down the key points of your argument to hold a class debate. After the debate, discuss which strategy or combination of strategies is the best for improving food supply.